

Common continuous distributions 2

Def. The gamma function is

$$\Gamma(\alpha) = \int_0^{\infty} e^{-x} \cdot x^{\alpha-1} dx, \quad \alpha > 0.$$

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$$\int u \cdot v' = u \cdot v - \int u' \cdot v$$

$$u = x^{\alpha-1}$$

$$v' = e^{-x}$$

$$u' = (\alpha-1)x^{\alpha-2}$$

$$v = -e^{-x}$$

$$= \cancel{x^{\alpha-1}} \cdot \cancel{e^{-x}} \cdot (-1) \Big|_0^{\infty} + (\alpha-1) \int_0^{\infty} x^{\alpha-2} e^{-x} dx$$

$$= (\alpha-1) \cdot \Gamma(\alpha-1)$$

$$\therefore \Gamma(\alpha) = (\alpha-1) \cdot \Gamma(\alpha-1)$$

▮ If $\alpha = 1$, then

$$\Gamma(1) = \int_0^{\infty} \cancel{x^{1-1}}^1 e^{-x} dx$$

$$= -e^{-x} \Big|_0^{\infty} = 1$$

▮ If $\alpha = 2$, then

$$\Gamma(2) = 1 \cdot \Gamma(1) = 1$$

▮ If $\alpha = 3$, then

$$\Gamma(3) = 2 \cdot \Gamma(2) = 2 \cdot 1 = 2 !$$

▮ If $\alpha = n$ is a positive integer, then

$$\Gamma(n) = (n-1) !$$

Def. A RV X is distributed gamma if

$$f_X(x) = \frac{x^{\alpha-1} \cdot \beta^\alpha}{\Gamma(\alpha)} \cdot e^{-\beta x}, \quad x > 0.$$

Notation: $X \sim \text{Ga}(\alpha, \beta)$, $\alpha > 0$, $\beta > 0$.

$$M_X(t) = \int_0^\infty e^{xt} \cdot \frac{x^{\alpha-1} \cdot \beta^\alpha}{\Gamma(\alpha)} e^{-\beta x} dx$$

$$= \int_0^\infty \frac{x^{\alpha-1} \cdot \beta^\alpha}{\Gamma(\alpha)} e^{-\boxed{(\beta-t)}x} dx$$

$\beta^* > 0 \Leftrightarrow t < \beta$

$$= \frac{\beta^\alpha}{(\beta^*)^\alpha} \int_0^\infty \frac{x^{\alpha-1} (\beta^*)^\alpha}{\Gamma(\alpha)} e^{-\beta^* x} dx$$

PDF of $\text{Ga}(\alpha, \beta^*)$

$$= \left(\frac{\beta}{\beta - t} \right)^\alpha, \quad t < \beta.$$

$$\text{iii) } E(X) = \frac{d}{dt} M_X(t) \Big|_{t=0}$$

$$= \beta^\alpha \cdot -\alpha \cdot (\beta - t)^{-\alpha-1} \cdot (-1) \Big|_{t=0}$$

$$= \alpha \cdot \beta^{-1}$$

$$\text{iv) } E(X^2) = \frac{d^2}{dt^2} M_X(t) \Big|_{t=0}$$

$$= \beta^\alpha \cdot \alpha \cdot -(\alpha+1) \cdot (\beta - t)^{-\alpha-2} \cdot (-1) \Big|_{t=0}$$

$$= \alpha \cdot (\alpha+1) \cdot \beta^{-2}$$

$$\text{v) } \text{Var}(X) = \alpha \cdot (\alpha+1) \cdot \beta^{-2} - (\alpha \cdot \beta^{-1})^2 = \alpha \cdot \beta^{-2}$$

▮ If $\alpha = 1$ and $\beta = \theta$, then

$$\text{Ga}(1, \theta) = \text{Exp}(\theta)$$

▮ THM. Consider independent $X_i \sim \text{Ga}(\alpha_i, \beta)$,
and let $S = X_1 + \dots + X_n$. Then

$$S \sim \text{Ga}\left(\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i, \beta\right)$$

$$M_S(t) = \prod_{i=1}^n M_{X_i}(t)$$

$$= \prod_{i=1}^n \left(\frac{\beta}{\beta - t} \right)^{\alpha_i}$$

$$= \left(\frac{\beta}{\beta - t} \right)^{\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i}$$

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MGF of  $\text{Ga}\left(\sum_{i=1}^n \alpha_i, \beta\right)$